

## **Maria Silva**

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Private Client Paralegal position with your Wills & Inheritance team in Wokingham. Having built practical legal experience across client advisory, document preparation and case management, I am looking to develop a long-term career within private client law and would welcome the opportunity to do so within a Legal 500 leading firm.

My current role at Citizens Advice East Berkshire involves advising clients directly on welfare, housing, family and debt matters — many of whom are in vulnerable circumstances. I take detailed factual statements, establish chronologies, identify legal and evidential issues, and manage matters from initial instruction through to submission. Translating complex statutory rules into clear, practical guidance for individuals under pressure is central to the work, and it is the aspect I find most rewarding. I see a natural connection between that client-facing discipline and the careful, relationship-led work that characterises a strong private client practice.

During my year-long placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, I developed a solid foundation in document drafting, procedural preparation and organised case-file management across both arbitration and real estate disputes. I prepared hearing bundles, drafted procedural documents, maintained structured electronic files and tracked deadlines across competing matters — including stepping up as the sole junior supporting an arbitration team in the weeks before a major submission deadline. A partner and associate commented that my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor.

At Q-Legal, I managed a data-privacy matter end to end under solicitor supervision: researching applicable law, identifying compliance risks and producing a formal written advice letter. The thread running through all of these roles is attention to detail, client-focused judgement and the ability to handle confidential, sensitive material responsibly.

I hold an LLB (2:1) from UCL and am completing an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution at Queen Mary, where my dissertation on cross-jurisdictional GDPR development was awarded a Distinction. I am based in Maidenhead, making the Wokingham office an easy commute.

I would welcome the chance to discuss how my background fits the team's needs.

Yours sincerely,  
Maria Fernanda Silva